

bcm, compared with 3,153.1 bcm in the previous year.

The US, Russia and Canada are the largest natural gas producing countries, while the US, Russia and Iran are the largest natural gas consuming countries in the world.

Indian Scenario

The balance recoverable natural gas reserves in the country is 1240.9 bcm, which accounts for only 0.6% of the world's total natural gas reserves.

The share of natural gas in the country's primary energy mix decreased to 9.8% in 2011 from 11% in 2010.

However, this share is quite low compared to the global average (24%), primarily due to the supply-side constraints.

The natural gas (including CBM) production in 2011 was 46.1 bcm, which is 12.8% higher than the actual production of 50.8 bcm in 2010.

India's consumption of natural gas was around 61.1 bcm in 2011, which accounts for only 1.9% of the world natural gas market.